Keg order for summer 2027

Wrenfold Brewery Ltd, supply chain. Prepared by Justin Francis for Kim Taylor, 7 December 2026.

Order 2,090 fifty-litre, 3,230 thirty-litre and 1,130 twenty-litre kegs by 18 December for the April delivery. The keg register's 21,897, 12,860 and 4,787 active kegs overstate the fleet by about 3,367, 1,980 and 497 kegs lost in the trade since the November 2023 reconciliation, and the Maplestead pubs' slow 30 litre lines and the widened Foundry range each need far more kegs than their volumes at the fleet's usual turns suggest.

	50 l	30 l	20 l
Kegs to buy	2,090	3,230	1,130
Usable fleet, 30 Nov 2026	18,530	10,880	4,290
Register says	21,897	12,860	4,787
Lost in the trade, year to Nov 2026	1,210	630	170
Busiest week's deliveries (80% range)	5,990 (5,970 to 6,370)	3,400 (3,390 to 3,550)	850 (850 to 890)
Fleet to cover in the busiest week	19,800	13,670	5,320

Why the register is not the fleet

The register still lists every keg that has gone missing since it was last reconciled. Counting what is on our sites at the stocktake and what the tagged kegs show is out with customers, the fleet at 30 November is 18,530, 10,880 and 4,290 kegs. The trade lost 1,210, 630 and 170 kegs in the year to November, once the other brewers' kegs the drivers bring back with ours are taken out of the empties and our kegs coming back through the exchange and the recovery agent are counted in.

What the new business needs

A pub line holds a keg on tap and its delivery cover whatever it sells, so the Maplestead pubs' lines, slow on 30 litre, will hold about 1,180 fifty-litre and 2,240 thirty-litre kegs in the busiest week. The 2027 Foundry range is brewed in 200-keg lots across up to 18 beers, so the cold store will hold about 2,280 full kegs in the twenty-litre busiest week.

How sure

At normal weather the busiest delivery week sends out about 5,990, 3,400 and 850 kegs (80 per cent ranges 5,970 to 6,370, 3,390 to 3,550 and 850 to 890 over the last ten summers). The order holds for each size across the methods we tried, within 1,900 to 2,250, 2,950 to 3,850 and 900 to 1,250 kegs. Normal weather is a smoothed average day, so its busiest week sits at the low end of the range real summers give: a real summer's hot week lifts its peak above the average's.